Refund Authorisation and Escalation Matrix

OPERATING PROCEDURE: KW-FIN-402 Title: Refund Authorisation and Goodwill Matrix Effective Date: 14 January 2025 Applies To: All Customer Operations Agents, Team Leads, Operations Managers, and Finance Approvers Owner: Director of Customer Operations Policy, Kartway

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE 1.1 This document establishes the strict monetary thresholds, approval hierarchies, and system constraints governing all financial redress, refunds, and goodwill credits issued by Kartway Customer Operations. 1.2 Compliance with this matrix is mandatory. Any deviation from the thresholds outlined herein constitutes a violation of internal controls and may result in disciplinary action under company policy KW-HR-119.

2. REFUND AUTHORISATION MATRIX 2.1 All refund requests must be processed through the internal CRM tool (OmniKart). The system enforces hard programmatic blocks based on the following authorisation tiers:

Authorisation Tier	Maximum Refund Limit (INR)	Mandatory Documentation / Conditions
Tier 1: Customer Operations Agent	Up to ■2,000	Standard return log or verified delivery failure.
Tier 2: Team Lead (TL)	■2,001 to ■10,000	Ticket escalation tag; verified customer photo proof for damaged items.
Tier 3: Operations Manager (OM)	■10,001 to ■50,000	Manager-approved exception log; vendor debit-note eligibility check.
Tier 4: Finance Department	Above ■50,000	Formal investigation report, legal/fraud review sign-off, and CFO/Treasury authorisation.

2.2 Automated System Restrictions: The automated Kartway resolution bot (`AutoKart-Bot`) is strictly capped at an auto-approval limit of ■2,000. Under no circumstances may the automated system auto-approve any refund exceeding ■2,000, regardless of the customer’s loyalty tier (e.g., Kartway Prime, Kartway Elite), historical lifetime value, or sentiment analysis scores generated by third-party tools. Any amount exceeding ■2,000 requires manual queue routing to the appropriate human tier.

3. GOODWILL CREDITS 3.1 Goodwill credits are non-monetary promotional balances issued to compensate for service failures (e.g., extreme delivery delays, carrier rudeness) where no direct product refund is legally or operationally warranted. 3.2 Goodwill Cap: The maximum goodwill credit an individual Customer Operations Agent may issue to a single customer account within a rolling 30-day period is ■500. Team Leads may authorise goodwill credits up to ■2,500. Any goodwill credit exceeding ■2,500 requires Operations Manager approval. 3.3 Stacking Prohibition: Goodwill credits may not be stacked with a full monetary refund on the same order. If a customer receives a 100% monetary refund for an order under Section 2, agents are strictly prohibited from issuing concurrent goodwill credits for that same transaction ID. Issuance of both on a single order triggers an automated compliance flag and a mandatory audit by the Fraud Operations Unit.

4. SPLIT TRANSACTIONS AND CIRCUMVENTION 4.1 Splitting a single refund request into multiple smaller transactions across separate tickets or agents to bypass the thresholds defined in Section 2 is classified as policy circumvention and gross misconduct. 4.2 All refunds issued against a single order number within a 14-day window are automatically aggregated by OmniKart to calculate the true authorisation tier requirement. Retroactive approvals must be secured if aggregated totals breach higher tier limits.